MONTHLY UPDATE

Somalia: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Legislation and regulation · Regional collaboration · Public debate and participation in policymaking

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity

DPI
Digital Identity and CRVS · Registries · Sectoral management information systems

TECHNOLOGY
AI

INCLUSION
Digital divides

DATA
Open data

Governance

Legislation and regulation

DRAFT PENAL CODE REPLACING THE 1962 CODE

- **Somalia Penal Code Reform Targets Cybercrime and Emerging Digital Offences** — Goobjoog English, 14 October 2026

  Draft replaces 1962 code with digital-offence provisions; Speaker, committee and justice minister meet; no vote date.

Regional collaboration

PEER-LEARNING COOPERATION WITH PAKISTAN ON DIGITAL IDENTITY AND PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Somalia and Pakistan deepen cooperation on digital identity and public infrastructure** — UNDP Pakistan, 16 September 2026

  Ten-day NIRA mission to Pakistan ends with a validated Somalia-Pakistan Partnership Action Matrix.

- **Peer Learning to Collaboration: Somalia & Pakistan Deepen Partnership on Digital Infrastructure** — Somali Stream, 19 September 2026

  NIRA registers ~2,000 a day against 200,000 capacity; 30-60-90-day action matrix; no national data exchange layer.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

STATE TAKEDOWN OF SOCIAL MEDIA PAGES

- **Somali government closes 82,000 extremist-linked social media pages in 2026** — Hiiraan Online, 4 September 2026

  Information ministry says 82,000 pages taken down in 2026, with Meta and TikTok cooperation claimed.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

BERBERA INTERNATIONAL GATEWAY ROUTE

- **Somaliland fibre route tests Kenya's regional digital edge** — Business Daily, 15 September 2026 KENYA ETHIOPIA SOUTH SUDAN

  Berbera is being positioned as an alternative digital gateway for landlocked Ethiopia and South Sudan, offering providers, businesses and governments another route to global data connections beside the established Mombasa gateway.

NATIONAL INTERCONNECTION BETWEEN OPERATORS

- **Somalia's mobile money remains locked in silos** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026

  The chief executive of Somalia's SomLink Telecom says voice calls now interconnect across six operators while mobile-money wallets remain closed to one another. He calls for cost-based pricing and shared rails, and says the largest operators have little commercial reason to open up.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

PROPOSED NATIONAL ID REQUIREMENT FOR SOCIAL MEDIA ACCOUNTS

- **The Ministry of Information Wants a Name Behind Every Somali Account** — The Somali Digest, 9 September 2026

  Deputy PM asks that a NIRA ID gate every social media account; dozens of documented Facebook takedowns.

- **Opinion: My Reflections on the Strategic and Communication Forum 2026** — Dawan Africa, 11 September 2026

  Named-analyst critique of the Mogadishu forum: no follow-up mechanism, and NIRA-gated accounts need a rights test.

BIOMETRIC PASSPORT AND TRAVEL-DATA EXCHANGE

- **Somali immigration agency, AU discuss border security and counterterrorism cooperation** — Hiiraan Online, 16 September 2026

  Somalia's ICA briefs the AU counterterrorism centre on biometric passports, e-Visa and travel-data exchange.

NATIONAL ID REQUIREMENT FOR SIM CARDS

- **National Identification Week 2026 Concludes in Mogadishu** — SONNA, 19 September 2026

  SIM cards to require National ID; 1.5m registered, 59 centres, 17 mobile teams, 31 embassy centres (19 Sep 2026).

NATIONAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **Somalia registers 1.5 million citizens under national ID system** — Hiiraan Online, 20 September 2026

  Somalia's identity authority has registered more than 1.5 million citizens since 2023, against a target of 15 million citizens and residents by 2029. The interior minister said issuance would extend to embassies abroad, with priority for persons with disabilities and displaced communities.

NATIONAL IDENTITY REQUIREMENT FOR DOMESTIC TRAVEL

- **Puntland passengers blocked from flights over NIRA ID requirement** — Hiiraan Online, 1 October 2026

  No NIRA registration offices in Puntland; Garowe passengers turned back as the ID-for-travel rule took effect.

NATIONAL IDENTITY INTEGRATION WITH THE HALMEEL PUBLIC SERVICE CENTRE

- **Somalia Moves to Link National ID with Public Services** — Goobjoog News, 6 October 2026

  Somalia's identity authority is moving to link its registration services to HALMEEL, the national unified public service delivery centre, where an area has been set aside for it. The aim is one national identity across several government services; the integration is planned and not yet in place.

Registries

SOMALILAND CREDIT REGISTRY

- **Somaliland oo Dardargelinaysa Horumarinta iyo Hir-gelinta Nidaamka Xogta Daymaha** — Wargeyska Dawan, 12 September 2026

  Hargeisa consultation 11 Sep 2026 with banks, ZAAD and eDahab; central bank to lead the credit information bureau.

IOM AND NETHERLANDS COMPASS MIGRATION MANAGEMENT PROGRAMME

- **IOM, Somalia and Netherlands Launch Migration Management Programme** — Dawan Africa, 7 October 2026

  IOM-Netherlands COMPASS programme: civil registration, legal ID in underserved areas, data protection, data sharing.

Sectoral management information systems

NATIONAL TRANSFORMATION PLAN DIGITAL MONITORING SYSTEM

- **Somalia Launches Digital System to Track National Transformation Plan** — Dawan Africa, 8 September 2026

  Unified monitoring across all 26 federal ministries; 153 donor-funded projects already reviewed.

Technology

AI

SAADAAL CLIMATE EARLY-WARNING SYSTEM

- **Somalia Participates in Africa Food Systems Forum in Rwanda** — Shabelle Media Network, 5 September 2026

  SoDMA building systems for full government ownership of disaster data, adviser tells AFS Forum panel.

Inclusion

Digital divides

SMARTPHONE FINANCING PROGRAMME

> - **Hormuud and GetPhone expand smartphone finance into four new Somali states due to high demand** — Soko Directory, 25 September 2026
>
>   Over 2,500 phones sold; 15 new branches in four states; sub-500 credit scores repaying 89.7% vs 90.5% at 650+.

Data

Open data

> DATACITE NATIONAL CONSORTIUM
>
> - **SomaliREN oo Soomaaliya ka hirgelisay dalladdii ugu horreysay ee qaran ee DataCite** — Dawan TV, 10 September 2026
>
>   Somalia's first DataCite national consortium; DOIs for 30-plus research and data types across universities.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-16**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SOM/SOM-monthly-2026-10-16.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0